

Annoyed that Heracles had succeeded, Eurystheus made the tasks increasingly difficult...

3 CATCHING THE GOLDEN HIND

The golden hind was a female deer belonging to the goddess Artemis. It had golden horns and was faster than any other creature on Earth. Heracles had to catch it alive but, unable to outrun it, he shot an arrow at the creature to make it stop. Artemis believed Heracles had tried to kill her beloved pet and would not let him touch it. Only when Heracles promised not to harm the deer again did she allow him to borrow it.



4 CAPTURING THE ERYMANTHIAN BOAR

The Erymanthian boar was a huge, fierce beast with long, sharp tusks. Heracles had to capture it. His friend Chiron, a centaur, advised him to lure the boar onto snowy ground, where it would get stuck. The plan worked and Heracles managed to catch it. When he arrived back at Eurystheus's palace, however, the king was so frightened of the boar he hid in a large vase until Heracles took it away.



5 CLEANING THE AUGEAN STABLES

Heracles's fifth task was to clean the stables of King Augeus, who owned thousands of cows. Their stables were disgustingly filthy. Heracles had an idea, however, and offered to clean the entire stables in a day, in exchange for some of the cattle. Augeus laughed and accepted the suggestion on the spot. Heracles proceeded to divert the local river, which flowed through the stables, washing away all of the muck in one great rush.



6 KILLING THE STYMPHALIAN BIRDS

Next, Heracles had to rid Lake Stymphalis of an enormous flock of birds that ate humans. He couldn't get near the birds on the lake, so he asked for Athena's help. She gave him a set of loud castanets, which he took to the top of a nearby mountain. When he clapped them, their sound echoed through the valley below. The noise frightened the birds into flight and Heracles was able to shoot them down with arrows.

